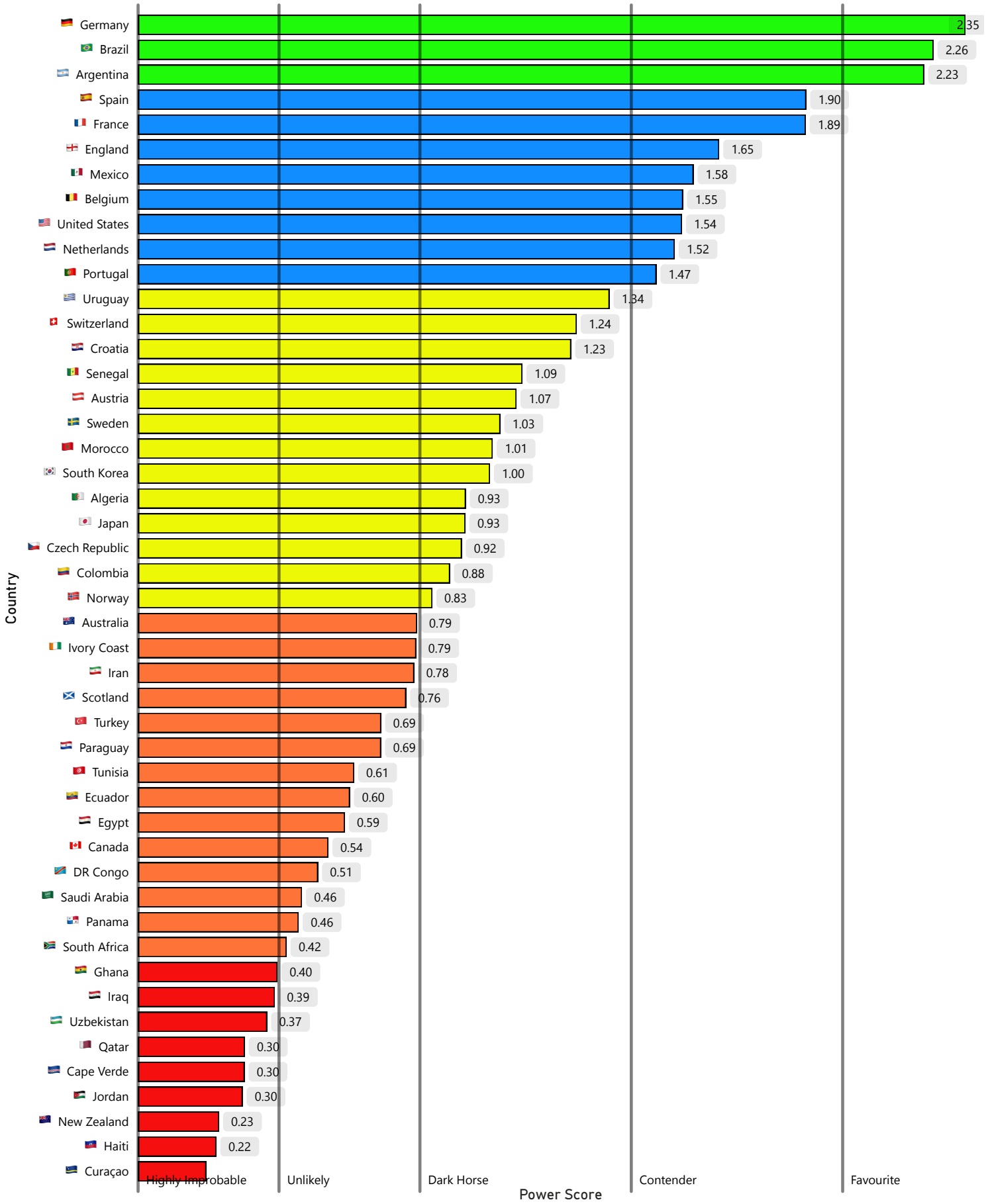
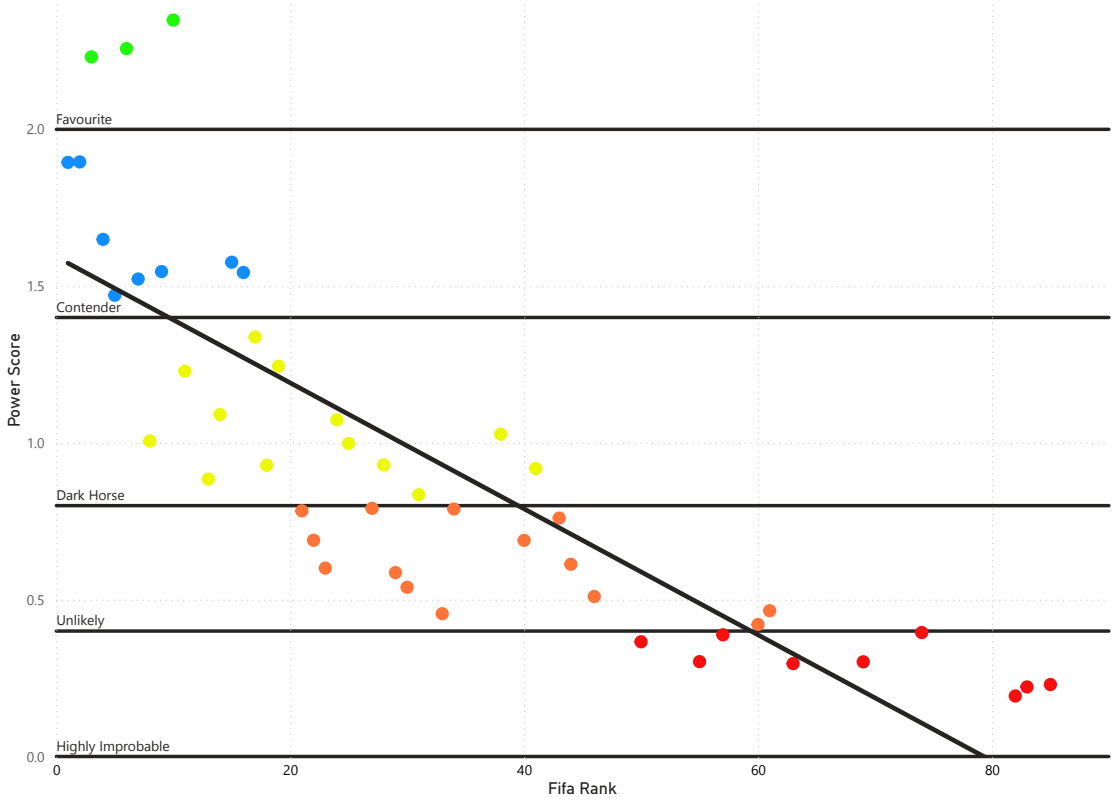
Power Score of Every World Cup Nation



Power Score vs FIFA Ranking: Identifying Dark Horses



Legend

Green = Favourite
Blue = Contender
Yellow = Dark Horse
Orange= Unlikely
Red = Highly Improbable

Teams above the trend line are outperforming their FIFA ranking, indicating potential dark horses.
The model reveals a strong alignment between the FIFA ranking and performance metrics, with very few teams significantly outperforming expectations. This suggests a lack of clear dark horse candidates, indicating that tournament outcomes are likely to be dominated by higher-ranked teams. For example, countries such as Japan, Colombia, and Morocco are ranked within the top 20; They fall well below the trend line, indicating that their overall power scores are marginally lower than expected for teams at that ranking. While they demonstrate strong recent form, their combined metrics, such as historical performance and ranking-adjusted strength, are not as strong as those of other similarly ranked teams.